

Ice Age

When freezing temperatures cause ice to cover large parts of the world, this is called an Ice Age. There were several Ice Ages during the Stone Age, but the last major one started about 110,000 years ago. It lasted for many thousands of years, ending around 10,000BCE. At its height, a third of the Earth was covered in ice. Living things had to learn to survive the cold. Ice Age humans made warm clothes and shelters from animal skins, fur, and bone.

The last great Ice Age started about 110,000 years ago.



Where?

Ice sheets up to 2 miles (4 km) thick could be found on five of the Earth's seven continents during the last great Ice Age. Some of this ice still exists today in Antarctica and Greenland.

Danger!

In many places, temperatures stayed below freezing throughout the year. People had to find ways of protecting themselves against the cold. Food became hard to come by because few plants could grow and many animals couldn't survive.



Humans

The first humans appeared and developed in Africa about 200,000 years ago. It was during a later Ice Age, about 130,000 to 90,000 years ago, that they started to spread. Over time, they traveled across the world.

Ice Age skull of a human

